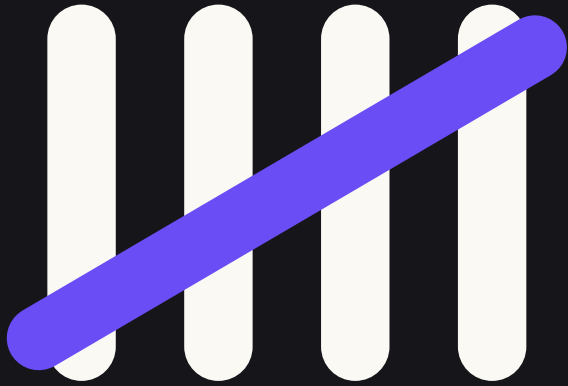




stash

Brand book and design guidelines

Version 1.0

The idea

Why a tally mark, and not a coin

Stash is a chore and rewards app. Children earn points for jobs around the house, parents verify the work, and points accumulate until the child spends them in a shop the parent stocks themselves.

The naming problem was easy. The visual problem was not. Cash stashes well because cash has volume. Points have none. They are a number in a database, and a number cannot be piled or hidden or held.

A tally mark solves it. It is the oldest way people have given an abstract count a body: four strokes and a slash through them. Nothing is borrowed from money. Bundles of five pile into bundles, so a stash reads as quantity without a jar or a coin anywhere near it.

What the mark carries

It counts.

Four uprights and a strike. The fifth point closes the bundle.

It belongs to the child.

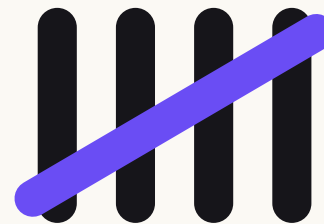
A tally is scratched, not issued. It reads as yours.

It spans the ages.

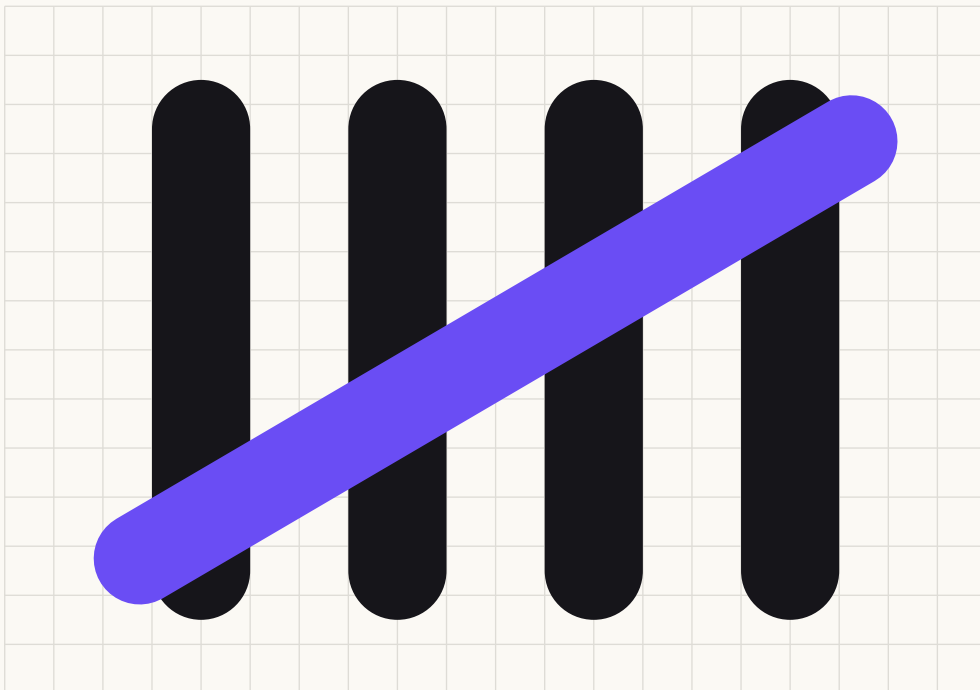
Legible to a four year old learning to count. Not embarrassing to a fifteen year old.

It is the product.

The mark draws itself as points are earned. The logo is the mechanic.



Construction



Specification

Unit (u)

The upright stroke width. Everything derives from it.

Upright

1u wide, 5.5u tall, fully rounded ends.

Pitch

2u between upright centres. Four uprights, three gaps.

Strike

0.94u wide, rising left to right at 30 degrees.

Overhang

The strike passes the outer uprights by roughly 0.6u each side.

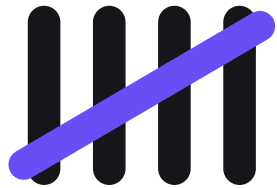
Ink box

8.19u wide by 5.5u tall, including the strike caps.

Always place the supplied vector files. Do not rebuild the mark in a design tool.

Logo variations

One mark, five approved forms. Pick by context, not by taste.



Primary mark

App icons, avatars, anywhere the name is already present



Horizontal lockup

The default. Website headers, documents, email signatures



Stacked lockup

Square spaces, merch, splash screens



Single colour

Embroidery, engraving, one-colour print, faxes



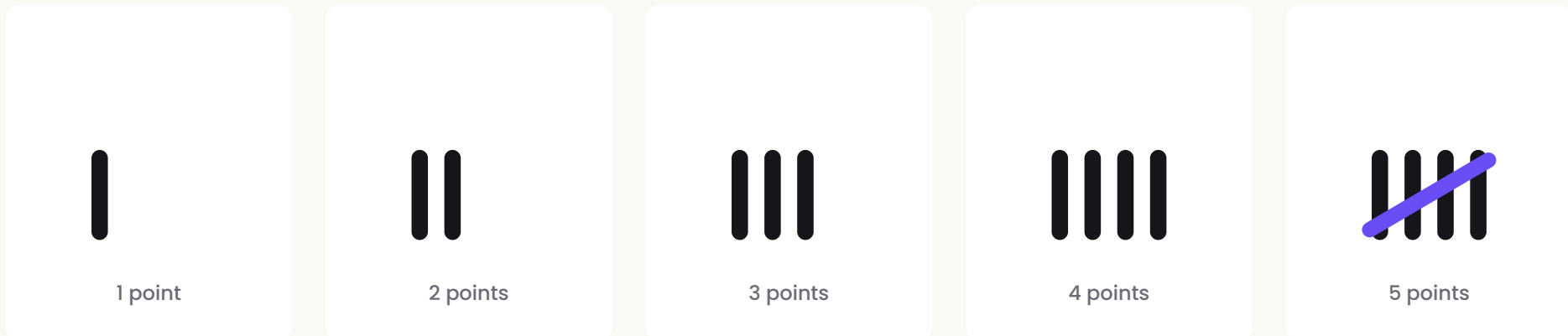
Reversed

On ink, on strike violet, on photography

The mark in motion

The logo is the reward mechanic. Use it that way.

Points are drawn, not printed. A stroke appears each time a parent verifies a task, and the fifth lands as the strike. Five is a bundle. Bundles stack. This is the only animation in the product that should ever feel like a small event.



- Stroke draw-on: 180ms, ease-out. The strike takes 260ms and may overshoot slightly.
- Never animate the mark when it is being used as a logo. Only when it is counting.
- A completed bundle can pulse once. It must not loop, bounce or sparkle.
- Pending tasks show the next stroke at 20 percent opacity. Nothing else hints at it.

Clear space and minimum size

Give it room. It is a small mark and it crowds easily.



Minimum clear space = 2u on every side

Minimum sizes

App icon

No lower limit. The tile protects it.

Mark, screen

20 px tall. Below that the uprights merge.

Mark, print

7 mm tall.

Horizontal lockup, screen

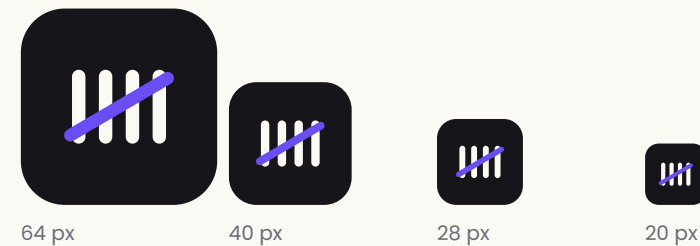
96 px wide.

Horizontal lockup, print

28 mm wide.

Favicon

Use the three-stroke favicon file below 24 px. Four strokes turn to mush.

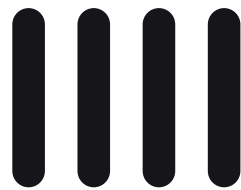


Misuse

All of these have been done to good marks. Do not do them to this one.



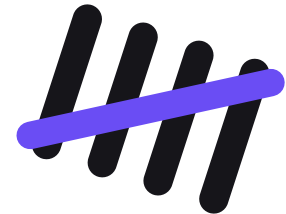
✗ Do not add strokes



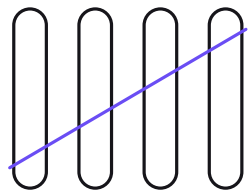
✗ Do not remove the strike



✗ Do not stretch or squash



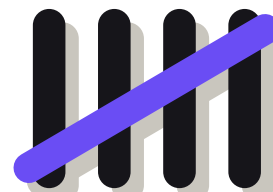
✗ Do not rotate



✗ Do not outline



✗ Do not recolour the uprights



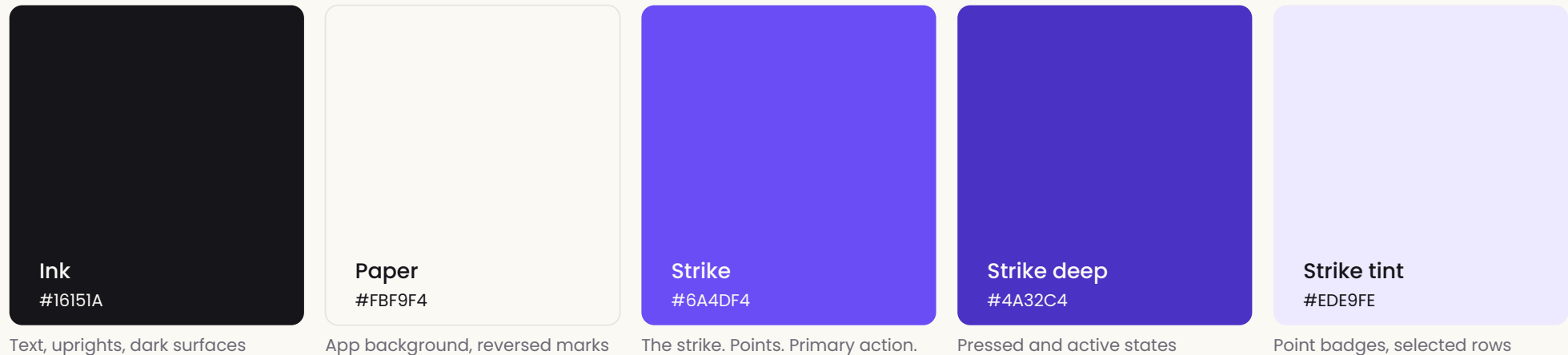
✗ Do not add effects



✗ Do not place on busy colour

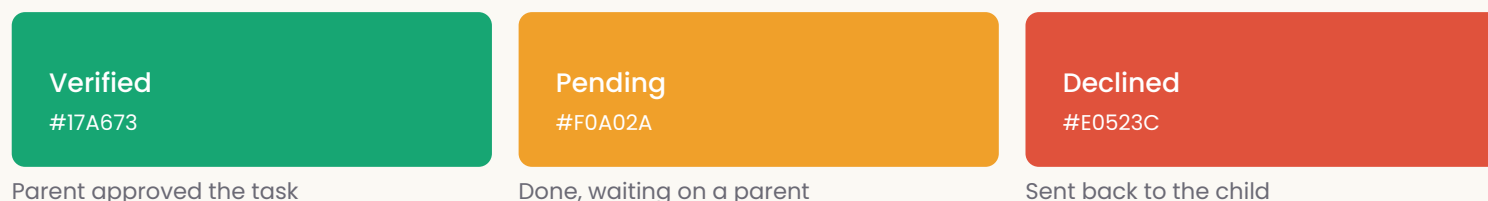
Colour

Ink and paper do the work. Violet is reserved for the strike and for reward.



Status colours

Used only for task state. Never for brand surfaces, never in the logo.



Contrast

Ink on paper is 15.9:1. Paper on strike violet is 5.1:1, which passes AA for body text and large text but not for text under 14px on violet. Put small text on ink or paper, never on violet.

Typography

Poppins throughout. One family, four weights, no exceptions.

Poppins is geometric enough to sit beside the mark and round enough that a child does not find it cold. It is free, it covers the weights we need, and it is on Google Fonts so developers can pull it without a licence conversation.

Aa Poppins
Light 300 Regular 400
Medium 500 Bold 700

App type scale

Display	34pt	Wash the dishes	Point balances, the number that matters
Title	22pt	Wash the dishes	Screen headings
Heading	16pt	Wash the dishes	Section headings, card titles
Body	15pt	Wash the dishes	Task names, descriptions, everything read at length
Label	12pt	Wash the dishes	Buttons, tabs, field labels
Caption	11pt	Wash the dishes	Timestamps, helper text, the smallest we go

Rules

- Never set body text below 15pt. Half the users are children.
- Numbers are always Bold. A point total is the loudest thing on the screen.
- Sentence case everywhere. No shouting, no title case in buttons.
- Line height 1.45 for body, 1.15 for display.

Voice

Two audiences on one screen. The tone shifts, the personality does not.

Talking to a child

Plain, short, never babyish. Say the thing. A ten year old can smell condescension from the next room, and a fifteen year old will delete the app over it.

Dishes done. 3 points.

Woohoo! You did it! Amazing job superstar!

Mum has to check this one.

Your task is pending parental verification.

You need 12 more.

Keep going, you can do it!

Talking to a parent

Calm and factual. Parents open this between other jobs. Tell them what needs a decision and get out of the way. Never nag them about their own children.

3 tasks waiting on you.

Don't forget to verify your children's chores!

Emma has 40 points saved.

Emma is on a roll this week!

Set what a point is worth.

Unlock the full power of your rewards shop.

Three things we never do

- Never use points as a threat. Points are earned, not taken away.
- Never gamify with streaks, leagues or loss. This is a household, not a casino.
- Never compare siblings. Ever.

In the product

How the brand behaves once it is an app.

Two front doors

A child opens Stash and sees their own tally and what to do next. A parent opens it and sees what needs verifying. Same app, different first screen. Neither has to navigate to the thing they came for.

The balance is the hero

The point total is the largest element on the child's home screen, set in Bold, in ink, with the tally beneath it. Everything else is quieter.

Verification is one tap

A parent should be able to clear a queue of five tasks in under fifteen seconds, from the notification if possible.

The shop is warm, not loud

Rewards are shown as photographs the parent uploads, priced in points. No banners, no countdowns, no artificial scarcity.

Age sets the task, quietly

Task assignment by age happens in the background. The child never sees a task they cannot do, and never sees the reason a task was withheld.

Spending feels good

Redeeming subtracts bundles. It never drains a bar or empties a jar. Taking from your own stash is the point of having one.

Asset index

What is in the folder and when to reach for it.

logo/svg

stash-mark.svg primary mark
 stash-mark-reversed.svg paper strokes, violet strike
 stash-mark-mono-ink.svg single colour
 stash-mark-mono-paper.svg single colour reversed
 stash-wordmark.svg wordmark only, outlined
 stash-wordmark-reversed.svg
 stash-lockup-horizontal.svg the default lockup
 stash-lockup-horizontal-reversed.svg
 stash-lockup-horizontal-mono.svg
 stash-lockup-stacked.svg
 stash-lockup-stacked-reversed.svg

logo/app-icon

stash-icon-ink.svg primary app icon
 stash-icon-paper.svg light tile
 stash-icon-strike.svg violet tile
 stash-favicon.svg three strokes, for 16 to 24 px

logo/ui

stash-count-1.svg through
 stash-count-5.svg
 The counting states. Use these in the app, not the logo files.

logo/png

App icons at 1024, 512, 180, 120, 60
 Lockups at 1024 and 2048 wide, transparent
 Favicons at 32 and 16
 Marks at 512 and 1024

Formats

SVG is the master in every case. The wordmark is outlined, so nothing depends on Poppins being installed. PNGs are exported from the same SVGs, so if the mark changes, regenerate rather than editing a PNG. Anything printed should use the SVG.

Still open

Trademark clearance against Stash Financial in the US, and the .co.za and .com domains. Neither has been checked.